



1. Activities in Antarctica can include kayaking among icebergs, hiking across polar terrain and even the traditional polar plunge into freezing waters

2. Travellers cross the Drake Passage, explore ice formations by Zodiac boats, land on ice sheets, watch penguin colonies

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Expeditions, Indian travellers are increasingly interested not only in Antarctica but also in the Arctic. Destinations such as Svalbard, known for polar bears and Arctic wildlife, and Greenland, with its massive glaciers and ice sheets, are becoming popular among Indian travellers seeking unusual and remote destinations. An 11-day cruise to the Svalbard archipelago that not only allows you to spot Arctic wildlife but also marvel at the spectacle of continuous daylight costs \$10,200 per person on Quark Expeditions. Best time to visit is from May-July.

In Antarctica, travellers can see penguin colonies, whales and seals against dramatic ice landscapes.

In the Arctic, the draw includes polar bears, walruses, reindeer and seabirds. However, the appeal goes beyond wildlife.

Kohli believes that the attraction lies in the rarity of access itself. "Access has become a form of luxury," she says.

Another notable trend is the changing demographic profile of polar travellers from India. Polar expeditions were once dominated by older travellers, often retirees with time and resources. Today, the market includes younger, financially independent travellers, as well as multi-generational families travelling together.

Food, comfort and cultural considerations remain important

even in remote regions. Expedition ships now offer fine dining, vegetarian and vegan options, and varying activity levels to suit different fitness levels, making polar travel accessible to a wider range of travellers.

The growing interest of Indian travellers in polar expeditions reflects a broader redefinition of luxury travel—defined by access, rarity, storytelling and personal transformation. It's not simply a holiday, but an expedition. It's not just a destination, but an experience that feels like a once-in-a-lifetime journey.

The ultimate luxury is no longer where everyone goes, but where only a few do. **BT**